

Lab: Agent Profiles in the Circle

Group Activity — Agents

Objective

Create a profile of each circle member as an Active Inference agent, mapping their generative models and exploring how the diversity of agents in the group creates opportunities for collective learning.

Materials

- Index cards (one per member)
- Pens or markers
- A shared large sheet of paper or whiteboard
- Your current crochet projects

Duration

45-60 minutes

Activity Steps

Step 1: Individual Agent Profiles (15 minutes)

Each member fills out an index card as their "Agent Profile." Include:

- **Stitches I Know** (list the stitches in your generative model)
- **Techniques I Am Learning** (current edges of your model)
- **Techniques I Would Like to Learn** (areas of high uncertainty / future prediction error)
- **My Specialty or Strength** (the area where your model is deepest)
- **My Crochet History** (brief: how long, who taught you, what tradition)
- **A Project That Surprised Me** (a time your predictions about a project were wrong)

Be honest and specific. There is no hierarchy here — a card that says "I know chain and single crochet" is just as valid as one listing twenty techniques.

Step 2: Share and Compare (15 minutes)

Go around the circle and read your cards aloud. As each person shares, notice: - Where do generative models overlap? (Shared knowledge) - Where do they differ? (Diversity of models) - Where does one person's strength match another's wish-to-learn? (Teaching opportunities)

Place the cards on the large paper, arranging them to show connections. Draw lines between cards where one person's specialty matches another's learning goal.

Step 3: Map the Collective Agent (10 minutes)

On the large paper, around the individual cards, write down what the **circle as a whole** knows and can do: - What is the circle's collective range of stitches? - What projects could the group tackle together that no one could do alone? - What is the group's collective aesthetic — what kinds of projects does it gravitate toward? - What are the group's blind spots — techniques no one knows?

Discuss: Does the collective generative model exceed any individual's model? In what ways?

Step 4: Prediction Error Exchange (10 minutes)

Pair up with someone whose profile is different from yours. Each person demonstrates one thing they know that the other does not — a stitch, a technique for holding yarn, a way of reading a pattern. Notice: - What prediction errors arise for the learner? - How does the teacher adjust their explanation? - What does the teacher learn from teaching?

Switch pairs if time allows.

Reflection Prompts

- Were you surprised by the range of knowledge in the group?
- Did you discover a match between your learning goal and someone else's specialty?
- How does seeing everyone as an "agent with a generative model" change how you think about skill differences in the circle?

- What would happen to the group's collective model if a member left? If a new member with a very different background joined?

Extension

Keep the Agent Profile cards and revisit them in a month. Has anyone's model expanded? Has someone learned the technique they wished for? Track the circle as a model-expansion machine in action.